

Seawall height in Sea Ranch Lakes

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

SEA RANCH LAKES • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88

New, substantially repaired or substantially rehabilitated seawalls in Sea Ranch Lakes must reach at least 5.0 ft NAVD88. Applications filed before 1 Jan 2035 can be approved at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if the wall is designed to be raised to 5.0 ft by 2050. The village code sets no maximum seawall height, but no wall may be built on top of a seawall.

The detail

MINIMUM	5.0 ft NAVD88 - LDC Sec. 6.01.06(C)(2)(a)
INTERIM	Applications submitted before 1 Jan 2035 may be permitted at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if designed and constructed to accommodate 5.0 ft NAVD88 by 1 Jan 2050 - Sec. 6.01.06(C)(2)(a)
WHOLE SHORELINE	substantial repair/rehab must cover the entire shoreline - Sec. 6.01.06(C)(2)(f)
NO WALL ON SEAWALL	no wall shall be erected atop a seawall - Sec. 6.01.06(B)
ADOPTED	Ord. No. 2021-02, 22 Sept 2021 - Sec. 6.01.06(C)
THE 15 FT WATERFRONT STRIP	Within 15 ft of the mean water line or property line, no hedge or fence over 3 ft and no impervious surface except the seawall itself - Sec. 6.01.06(A)
WALLS NEAR THE WATER	No wall over 4 ft between the waterfront and the nearest setback line, and every wall needs the Committee's written approval - Sec. 6.01.06(B)
HOW HEIGHTS ARE MEASURED	Wall and fence heights are measured from the existing elevations of the adjacent property, and the Committee's ruling on any height question is conclusive - Sec. 6.01.06(B)
DOCKS	Lots on interior waters may not have docks, piers or boathouses at all; Intracoastal lots need plans approved by the Army Corps and in writing by the Committee - Sec. 6.01.05

Where this comes from: Sea Ranch Lakes Code, Appendix A (Land Development Code) Sec. 6.01.06(C) (Ord. No. 2021-02); Secs. 6.01.05 and 6.01.06(A)-(B)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.